



What's New in Java 12?

Java 12 was released in March 2019. This new, improved version has incorporated many language changes, all of which are outlined in this article.

Even with a new version of Java released every six months, there are quite a few language changes and under-the-hood improvements in this version. Let's cut to the chase and explore some of the major features in this release.

JEP 325: Switch expressions

Prior to Java 12, a switch statement was just a multi-way branch statement. Starting with Java 12, switch can also be used as an expression.

The previous design of Java's switch statement closely follows languages such as C and C++ and supports fall-through semantics, by default. In addition to the current fall-through code via the 'case : labels' syntax, additional 'case -> labels' syntax is added. Let's explore this with an example.

With fall-through logic using the ':' operator, the code is:

```
public class MyClass {
    public static void main(String args[]) {

        int n = 1;
        switch (n) {
            case 1:
                System.out.println("1");
            case 2:
                System.out.println("2");
            default:
                System.out.println("Another Number");
        }
    }
}
```

The output of the above code will be as follows:

```
1
2
Another Number
```

With no fall-through logic using the '->' operator, the code is:

```
public class MyClass {
    public static void main(String args[]) {

        int n = 1;
        switch (n) {
            case 1 -> {
                System.out.println("1");
            }
            case 2 -> {
                System.out.println("2");
            }
            default -> {
                System.out.println("Another Number ");
            }
        }
    }
}
```

The output of the example is shown below:

```
1
```